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WHAT'S NEW?

by indiefferential

MARY BETH ORR | WHAT'S NEW SEP VOL .3

Mary Beth Orr

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Do you remember that time you discovered your favorite band? What was that like? How did it feel? Over the years we have found different ways of discovering new music and other formats of entertainment. Some of you already remember the first time you bought a vinyl record or a CD.

For me, it was one of the best experiences when I bought an AC/DC CD freshly bought ready to be played at full volume in my parent's Hi-Fi system. The physical aspect of the release always was something that stayed with me for a long time and I loved the whole experience of having that CD, inserting it into the system, controlling the volume and listening to my favorite tracks over and over again. Everything that came along with the CD was a bonus, you could look at pictures, read about the band and have something to do while experiencing their music.

Right now most music is released in digital formats and you can't really experience this. Magazines were also something that introduced me to my favorite bands back in the day. I remember reading about the Killers long before listening to their hits on the radio. Still, the physical aspect of the discovery was significant, for me at least. Of course, it's a lot easier to find out great music these days and not buy seven different CDs to discover what you like.

Enough with the past though, let's move to today, you can stream music, films and series and many people don't bother buying magazines or CDs. I am one of these people who loves to collect things and I also own many video games in digital and physical format. Even though some of my favorite video games are in a library on my computer, I always cherish the time I take to look through the case of an older video game, its pamphlets and artwork.

This is one of the reasons we started Indiefferential. The experience of holding a physical magazine in your hands, reading about these new bands from the other side of the world while you listen to their music online sending them a DM that you love their work. This is what Indiefferential is all about, keeping the good aspects of physical releases and combining this experience with the modern opportunities technology provides.

Indiefferential is here for every artist out there, we love what we do and we will keep posting about your music and projects so people can find out their new favorite artist. **Our plan is to post consistently about new artists and creators, in that way, your audience will find out about another great band and their audience will discover your work. This is how Indiefferential works, always supporting artists in order to find the right audience and have their work sent across the whole world.**

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Ophelia Moon Illuminates the Power of Creativity with "Muse, Maestro, Melody Maker"

Philadelphia's Ophelia Moon continues to carve a distinctive path in contemporary music with their latest release, Muse, Maestro, Melody Maker. Written by Darren O. Moon and Maya Mikity, and performed vocally and instrumentally by Mikity, the track celebrates the profound impact of creative influence. Known for their explorations of life's grand mysteries, passion, joy, suffering, spirituality, and rebirth—Ophelia Moon crafts music that is both introspective and expansive.

Now Playing...

Muse, Maestro, Melody Maker is no exception: it intertwines rich instrumentation with emotive vocals to capture the magic of artistic inspiration and the ripple effect of creativity on human experience.

This release follows a string of compelling tracks including Magic and Daffodils, Color Me Dead, Banter of Wolves, and Memory Fades, each showcasing the group's ability to blend thoughtful lyricism with evocative soundscapes. With Muse, Maestro, Melody Maker, Ophelia Moon continues to invite listeners into a reflective, almost meditative sonic journey—one that emphasizes the beauty and transformative power of artistic expression.

The project positions Ophelia Moon as a voice for those who seek music that challenges the mind, touches the heart, and celebrates the mysterious, often spiritual forces that shape human creativity.



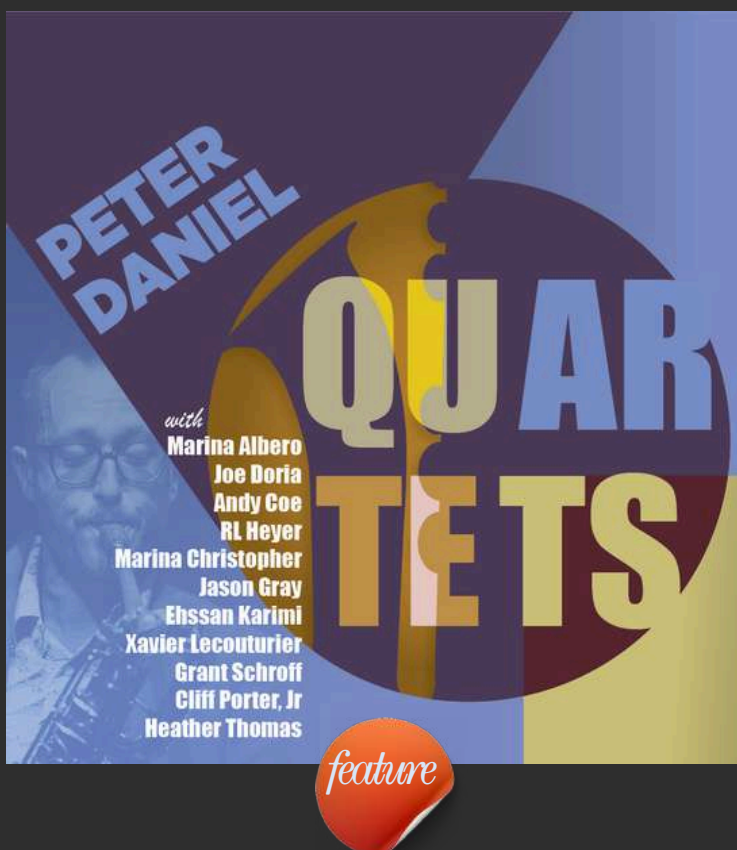
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For years, Peter Daniel's saxophone has been a steady force in the background, carrying the weight of melodies that lifted artists like Lauryn Hill, Father John Misty, and ODESZA. From touring internationally to shaping the sounds of bands such as The True Loves and The Polyrythmics, he has built a reputation as one of the Pacific Northwest's most reliable sidemen. But in 2025, Daniel takes a decisive step into the spotlight with *Quartets*, his debut solo album, arriving June 20 through Music Factory Records.

The record's title is both literal and conceptual. Each of the ten tracks is performed with a different rhythm section, forming a series of quartets that highlight Daniel's compositions through shifting textures and personalities. What might sound like a fragmented approach instead comes together as a unified statement, bound by the saxophonist's commanding tone and the pulse of the Pacific Northwest's jazz and funk community.

It is a project rooted as much in collaboration as in Daniel's own vision, a balancing act between individuality and collective spirit.

From the opening moments, *Quartets* asserts itself as a body of work meant to move both the head and the body. The lead single "Miles Around," already circulating in digital spaces, sets the tone with a buoyant rhythm section that locks into Daniel's sax lines like they have been waiting for the cue all along. The interplay feels conversational, the rhythm responding to the horn and the horn riding the groove, creating a call-and-response that feels alive in the moment.



Peter Daniel Steps Forward with Quartets: A Jazz-Funk Testament to Community and Groove

"Take A Little Chance" bursts with optimism, its syncopated percussion and fluid bass line giving Daniel space to soar with bright, almost vocal phrasing. By contrast, "Desperate Waltz" slows the tempo and turns inward, the drums brushing softly against a walking bass that feels weighted with contemplation. The cinematic "Come Back Together" and its haunting reprise stretch across a

wide canvas, layering rhythm and melody into a narrative arc that feels like film music, as if each chord change is another scene. Tracks like "Pedro Azul" and "Cliff's Notes vol 3" showcase Daniel's talent for melodic storytelling. His saxophone never feels ornamental, always leading with intention and grounding itself in the rhythm. The percussion throughout the album is

vital, whether delivering tight funk syncopation or easing into looser jazz phrasing. Each rhythm section leaves its fingerprint while keeping the spotlight fixed on the compositions themselves. The production favors warmth and clarity, a choice that reflects the community-centered ethos of the project. Recorded with musicians Daniel has known and played with for years, the sessions capture more than technical proficiency—they capture trust. You can hear it in the ease of transitions, in the way a bass line anticipates a shift in the horn, in the subtle push-and-pull of drummers who know exactly when to lean forward and when to lay back.

For Daniel, the album is a culmination of years on the sidelines, a chance to gather the energy of a scene that thrives on collaboration and present it in one place. "Each track came to life with a different group of musicians I've known and played with for years," he explains. "The goal was to capture the energy of community, and to let each quartet bring something unique to the table." That goal is fully realized. The record feels like a conversation between old friends, each track another story told with conviction and joy.

The release is supported by Music Factory Records, a label deeply embedded in the Pacific Northwest's creative ecosystem. With vinyl pre-orders available and a series of live shows lined up across Washington, including Bellingham, Seattle, and Olympia, Daniel is poised to bring *Quartets* to life on stage, where his music has always found its truest expression.



Mike Vorpai

DE LAURENTIIS ENTERTAINMENT GROUP PRESENTS
A MICHAEL MANN FILM

MANHUNTER

A RICHARD ROTH PRODUCTION A MICHAEL MANN FILM "MANHUNTER" WILLIAM PETERSEN KIM CREST JOAN ALLEN BRIAN COX
DENNIS FARINA STEPHEN LANG AND TOM NOONAN EDITED BY DOV HOENIG PRODUCTION DESIGNER MEL BOURNE DIRECTOR OF PHOTOGRAPHY DANTE SPINOTTI
EXECUTIVE PRODUCER BERNARD WILLIAMS BASED ON THE BOOK "RED SANDS" BY THOMAS HARRIS SCREENPLAY BY MICHAEL MANN PRODUCED BY RICHARD ROTH DIRECTED BY MICHAEL MANN

"IT'S JUST YOU AND ME NOW, SPORT..."

MV

MEMBER OF THE POSTER POSSE BOOK "MANN UP" DIRECTOR "MANN" IS THE NAME OF MICHAEL MANN

Portland has always carried a reputation for harboring musicians who thrive in the shadows, who build sound not just to entertain but to confront, to provoke, to drag emotion through distortion and reverb until something raw emerges. Mike Vorpals debut solo EP *Memes*, released on February 14, 2025, arrives in that spirit. It is a record that trades in atmosphere and abrasion, a six-track plunge into irony, alienation, and release.

Known previously for evocative songwriting and immersive arrangements in collaborative projects, Vorpals move into solo territory feels like a sharpening of focus rather than a departure. *Memes* is steeped in dark wave textures, but it carries a distinctly guitar-driven core that owes as much to grunge as it does to post-punk. The result is a sound that seethes with menace while keeping its grip tight on melody and rhythm.

"Manhunter," one of the EP's centerpiece tracks, captures this balance with chilling precision. The song opens like a predator moving in slow motion, guitars churning in low-register growls while reverb drifts over the top like heavy fog. There is no rush to the crescendo. Instead, Vorpals builds tension through repetition and density, letting the track stalk its way forward until it explodes into violent sonic assaults. The guitars snarl with grunge-fed aggression, recalling early Nirvana, but they are tempered by the cinematic swell of post-rock and the shadowy pulse of darkwave.

Percussion drives this atmosphere with an almost martial insistence. The beats hit with cold weight, sometimes stripped down to near silence, sometimes hammering with enough force to shake the low end apart. This rhythmic control keeps the track hypnotic even at its most chaotic. It is the heartbeat of the record, anchoring the shifting layers of distortion and synth that seem determined to collapse under their own heaviness. The mixing brings clarity to the storm without polishing away its danger. Guitars occupy the midrange with jagged intensity,

What makes *Memes* intriguing is its refusal to settle into one emotional register. Yes, it is dark and relentless, but it is also oddly hypnotic, even seductive. "Manhunter" embodies this duality. It feels like both a warning and a lure, a song that unsettles while daring you not to turn away. The aggression never loses its sense of control, and that control makes the track all the more unsettling. As a debut, *Memes* is not tentative. It arrives fully formed, with the confidence of an artist who knows how to shape sound into something both deeply personal and universally unsettling. For

Mike Vorpals Memes: Darkwave Fury Meets Guitar- Driven Confession

while the low end hums like an engine barely holding together. Vocals are layered with reverb yet remain distinct, cutting through the haze with unnerving directness. Vorpals delivery is icy, measured, almost surgical, which makes the cryptic lyrics hit harder. They arrive less like confessions and more like coded messages, forcing the listener to lean in, to piece together meaning in the fog.

Vorpals irony is not just a lyrical theme but a sonic condition, embedded in every distorted riff and every echoing vocal line. If "Manhunter" is the EP's dark heart, then the rest of *Memes* beats with the same conviction—guitars and synths colliding in an exploration of modern disconnection, rhythms that pin the listener down even as the atmosphere threatens to consume them.



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Lost Velvet is not just another name emerging from the UK music scene—it's a sonic experience that feels like stepping into a flickering reel of forgotten cinema, where shadows linger and melodies echo with a haunting familiarity. The duo, comprised of multi-instrumentalist Robert Butcher and vocalist Melissa Morris, has quickly carved out their own niche, merging grunge grit, post-rock expansiveness, and pop accessibility into a sound that resonates like a dream half-remembered yet impossible to forget. Since their debut single *Endless* in April 2025, Lost Velvet has captured the ears of tastemakers and casual listeners alike.

Lost Velvet: Painting a Haunting Dreamscape of Sound

The track introduced the world to their atmospheric style, layered guitars, moody textures, and the ethereal interplay of Morris and Butcher's voices. It was the kind of debut that felt less like an introduction and more like a declaration: Lost Velvet was here to leave an imprint. The single was quickly picked up by BBC *Introducing*, an early nod of approval that only amplified the buzz around the band.

Their momentum didn't falter with their sophomore release, *Wasted*, in June. If *Endless* painted wide cinematic skies, *Wasted* grounded listeners in a more visceral emotional space, its raw intensity balanced by the duo's refined production choices. Once again, BBC *Introducing* recognized the track, cementing Lost Velvet as one of the most promising acts of the year.



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On August 22nd, 2025, the band unveiled Make It Alright, their most ambitious single to date. With its haunting hooks and cinematic layers, the track feels like the culmination of the sonic world they've been building—both intimate and vast, both nostalgic and forward-thinking. It's the kind of song that doesn't just play in your headphones; it envelops you, demanding full immersion. And yet, Lost Velvet is only just beginning to unfurl their vision. An EP, due on September 26th, will compile their recent singles along with bonus tracks, offering listeners a more expansive view of their evolving artistry. But perhaps the most anticipated milestone is their debut album, Dark Cells, slated for release before the end of 2025. Early whispers suggest it will be a record steeped in mood and emotion, balancing grunge's raw energy with the sprawling, cinematic sensibilities that have already become their hallmark. At the heart of Lost Velvet's sound is the undeniable chemistry between Butcher and Morris. Butcher's multi-instrumental prowess lays the foundation, textures that swell, crash, and bloom, while Morris's vocals add a spectral quality that feels both vulnerable and commanding. Together, they create a dual-vocal dynamic that feels rare in today's landscape: a true partnership where each voice amplifies the other. Lost Velvet's music is not about quick thrills or fleeting trends. It's about atmosphere, storytelling, and pulling the listener into a world where beauty and melancholy intertwine. In an era dominated by instant hits and disposable singles, they stand apart by crafting songs that linger long after the last note fades. As 2025 draws to a close, one thing is clear: Lost Velvet is a band not just worth watching, but worth losing yourself in. Their sound is the soundtrack of a dream you never want to wake from.





Exclusive Feature

Orr brings not only artistry but authority to this daring concept. Currently 3rd Horn of the Grand Rapids Symphony, she has performed with ensembles such as the Detroit Symphony and Charleston Symphony. Her solo career is decorated with accolades including first prize at the International Women's Brass Conference Solo Competition (2019) and the Golden Classical International Music Awards.

When classical hornist and folk vocalist Mary Beth Orr released *The Singing Horn* on Big Round Records in March 2025, she unveiled more than an album, she offered a musical autobiography. Spanning 26 tracks, the project threads Appalachian folk melodies with the gravitas of the classical canon, binding two worlds that rarely converge. It is, as Orr describes, “a love letter to my life, and to yours.”

The recording is both intimate and expansive. Listeners move from the timeless comfort of the gospel hymn “I’ll Fly Away” to Gustav Mahler’s *Songs of the Wayfarer*, discovering a throughline where horn and human voice share expressive power. The first five tracks, flowing like a song cycle, weave folk and classical textures before culminating in the haunting “Oh Death.” Later, works such as *Good and True*, inspired by the birthing song of the Dagara Tribe described by Sobonfu Somé, showcase Orr’s deep curiosity about the global resonance of sound. Her Appalachian roots, love of classical repertoire, and raw honesty about motherhood, love, and grief all find space within the album’s arc.

Critics and juries have already taken notice. In 2025, *The Singing Horn* received the Silver Outstanding Achievement Award from the Global Music Awards. But accolades are not what drive Orr’s work. Instead, it is connection. She hopes her blending of horn and voice will illuminate how deeply folk traditions and classical music have always spoken to one another—and, ultimately, how they both speak to the human spirit.

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*Mary Beth Orr’s
The Singing
Horn: Bridging
Voice, Tradition,
and the French
Horn*

Her chamber music collaborations include appearances at the St. Augustine Music Festival and New York City’s Vox Novus Fifteen Minutes of Fame Project, where she performed fifteen commissioned miniatures written expressly for her. A new commission cycle is already underway for a 2026 premiere, further cementing her role as an advocate for living composers. Yet for all her international presence, Orr remains deeply grounded. She makes her home in Howard City, Michigan, with her husband, newborn son, and an ever-rotating family of rescue animals.





She is a certified yoga teacher (RYT 500), crediting yoga with providing balance in the high-pressure life of a professional musician. When time allows, she paints, gardens, and writes songs, further proof that her artistry stretches well beyond the concert hall.

With *The Singing Horn*, Mary Beth Orr has achieved something rare: a body of work that bridges traditions without diluting their essence. It is a meditation on life's contradictions, folk and classical, loss and renewal, grief and joy, told through two instruments that, in her hands, feel inseparable.



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John Smyths: From Rock Roots to Country Soul



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Some musicians take the long road before finding their true voice. For Johan Smits, known to fans as John Smyths, that journey has spanned decades, countries, and genres, ultimately leading him to carve a place in the modern country scene while holding onto the raw rock energy that first shaped his musical DNA.

Born in Nijmegen, Netherlands, in March 1961, Smyths was immersed in music from an early age thanks to his parents and older brother. While the records spinning at home weren't always his favorites, they sparked the curiosity that would later blossom into a lifelong passion. By the time his "wild years" had settled, Smyths found himself increasingly drawn to the storytelling and soul of country music. Icons like Conway Twitty, Hank Williams, Waylon Jennings, Kenny Rogers, and Tammy Wynette became the soundtrack to his evolution, providing the foundation for the artist he would become.

Relocating to Germany proved pivotal. There, Smyths began frequenting studios, recording covers of classic country songs and even stepping into songwriting with three original tracks of his own. Performing across Germany and Belgium, he gained a reputation as a dedicated live performer, delivering heartfelt renditions that bridged his love of traditional country with the grit of his earlier rock influences.

It may surprise some that before he embraced the world of country, Smyths was steeped in hard rock. As a teenager, his ears were tuned to Kiss, Van Halen, Iron Maiden, and AC/DC. That rock sensibility never fully disappeared; rather, it fused with the warmth and storytelling of country, giving Smyths a unique sound that straddles both worlds. This crossover appeal has become a defining feature of his artistry.



His latest single, *Now I'm Wiser*, captures this blend perfectly. A great country-rock track at its core, the song is powered by crisp, resonant guitars and Smyths' commanding vocals. There's a soulful rasp in his delivery that brings depth to the lyrics, while the instrumentation drives the song forward with both precision and heart. It's the kind of track that pays homage to the golden era of country rock while still feeling fresh and immediate. The combination of soaring guitar lines and Smyths' expressive voice creates an anthemic quality, one that listeners can imagine echoing across festival fields or filling intimate halls with equal force. Though he only recently began releasing music digitally under the John Smyths moniker, Smyths is no newcomer. His singles, available on streaming platforms, showcase the versatility of an artist who has spent years honing his craft away from the spotlight.

They're a testament to his willingness to embrace modern platforms while staying true to classic songwriting traditions. 2025 has been a milestone year for Smyths. His stage presence has taken him to towns across Germany and the Netherlands. Each performance is marked by an authenticity that reflects both his years of experience and his deep connection to the music he plays. But the year's biggest moments are still unfolding. Smyths is set to grace the stage at the prestigious Red Carpet Show International in Wageningen, Netherlands. There, he'll not only perform but also represent a new wave of country artists blending tradition with personal reinvention. His nominations are a testament to his impact: Country Voice of the Year, Country Blues Original, Country Song of the Year (Original), and Songwriter of the Year. Later, he'll join the lineup at the Country Messe in Erfurt, one of Europe's key showcases for the genre.

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Church of Elder Resurfaces with “Into the Waters”



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here is a kind of music that doesn't just play through speakers but seems to alter the atmosphere around it. Church of Elder's new single "Into the Waters" belongs firmly in that realm, a song that balances intimacy and grandeur, threading together longing, loss, and the quiet hope of reunion into something at once fragile and immense.

Formed in Fulda in 1985 by Mario Kurätzki and Norman Meiritz, Church of Elder has carried with it a long history of reinvention. What began as a youthful experiment in a school band eventually morphed through different incarnations, the Smalltown Band, then Killarney, before settling into the identity that has endured: Church of Elder. Through those decades, the group has navigated shifts in sound and style while holding onto a spirit of collaboration rooted in lifelong friendship. That shared history reverberates through their music, lending it a depth that cannot be manufactured.

L

ondon singer-songwriter Tom Minor has always had a knack for turning private turmoil into something listeners can hum along to. His new single, “The Loneliest Person on Earth,” released July 4 on all digital platforms, takes that instinct to its sharpest edge yet. The track unfolds like a confessional wrapped in melody, where regret and honesty collide in the glow of late-night city lights. At first listen, the song feels deceptively gentle. Its laidback, ballad-like rhythm lures you into a calm sway, but the lyrics reveal a different story. Minor is excavating the messy reality of domestic breakdowns, the moments when love is still

present but everything else is unraveling. The verses feel like unfiltered thoughts blurted out in the heat of the moment, the kind of confessions you can’t take back. That tension between soothing melody and raw candor gives the track its bite. The production, handled by Teaboy Palmer (playfully billed as “the Shel Talmy of Shoot Up Hill, NW2”), adds to the sense of intimacy. Palmer keeps the arrangement stripped enough to highlight Minor’s voice and words, but there’s an undercurrent of grit that nods to indie and garage rock traditions. The rhythm section pulses steadily, never flashy, allowing the guitar lines to shimmer with just enough distortion to suggest unease.

Tom Minor’s “The Loneliest Person on Earth” Finds Poetry in the Fallout

You can almost hear the city outside the window, pressing in on the quiet storm playing out inside. Lyrically, Minor gets at something universal: the suddenness with which a relationship can teeter. One minute, the person across from you is everything, the next, words are flying out of your mouth that you wish you could reel back in. “The Loneliest Person on Earth” doesn’t try to romanticize these moments. Instead, it acknowledges them, turns them over, and finds a melody that sits somewhere between mourning and release.

For Minor, the song represents the core of his musical identity. Raised in London N1 and steeped in a wide-ranging mix of influences—indie rock, new wave, punk, power pop, psychedelic garage, soul, and R&B—he’s spent years writing under the radar, lending words and hooks to others. But with his recent solo work, he’s carved out a lane that critics have begun to call “existential indie.” It’s music that leans into personal unease without losing sight of craft, songs that find clarity in ambiguity.

What makes “The Loneliest Person on Earth” resonate is its balance of immediacy and reflection. You can play it on a loop, drawn in by the hook, but with each listen, the lyrics cut a little deeper. It captures the paradox of modern relationships, where intimacy can feel both fragile and claustrophobic, where a single night can shift the entire ground beneath you.



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What makes “The Loneliest Person on Earth” resonate is its balance of immediacy and reflection.

Tom Minor isn't just adding another single to the crowded indie landscape, he's sharpening a voice that speaks directly to the contradictions of city life and modern love. “The Loneliest Person on Earth” is proof that even in isolation, music can pull us into a shared experience, one where regret, tenderness, and resilience coexist in the same breath.



ALIN KEILEN TURNS SATIRE INTO FURY ON “AYIWCTP”

Modern metal has no shortage of brute force, but Alin Keilen’s new single “AYIWCTP” is the rare track that weaponizes both heaviness and wit. Short for And Yet I Will Continue To Procreate, the song takes on the absurdities of contemporary society with irony sharp enough to cut through its own wall of sound. Out now on all streaming platforms, it’s a release that demands not just movement, but thought.

From the first downstroke, “AYIWCTP” makes its intent clear. The guitars lurch into a djent-inspired groove, their tone serrated and guttural, locking into a muscular rhythm section that refuses to play it safe. The riffs are groovy but complex, flipping between pounding chugs and jagged polyrhythms. There’s a precision in the playing that recalls the mechanics of progressive metal, yet the music never loses its visceral drive. Every shift feels calculated to jolt the listener, to break patterns just as they start to settle.

Keilen’s vocal delivery is just as disciplined. Instead of leaning on exaggerated growls or gratuitous screams, he keeps the urgency tight and focused, matching intensity with restraint. The effect is striking: the voice becomes another rhythmic instrument, guiding the track’s ebb and flow, surging when the guitars demand a push, holding back when the space needs tension. The balance between ferocity and control gives “AYIWCTP” its staying power, ensuring it doesn’t blur into the background noise of heavy music’s endless onslaught.

Lyrically, the single is where Keilen’s intent crystallizes. The title itself is a provocation, a jab at the persistence of humanity despite what he frames as a broken societal framework. The song reads like a dialogue between rage and resignation, a critique delivered with dark wit. In a world marked by instability and fatigue, the irony of continuing to procreate feels like both an act of defiance and an acknowledgment of absurdity.



Production-wise, the track thrives on contrast. The guitars dominate with layered textures, thick enough to feel like a physical presence, while the bass grounds everything in an ominous rumble. Percussion is crisp and deliberate, pushing the groove forward while highlighting the rhythmic complexity of the riffs. The mix ensures that no element drowns out another; instead, the parts snap together like gears, grinding but purposeful. It’s aggressive music that doesn’t collapse under its own weight.

What makes “AYIWCTP” notable is its refusal to separate the visceral from the cerebral. It’s a song you can headbang to without apology, yet one that lingers after the distortion fades. Keilen positions himself not just as a craftsman of riffs, but as an observer of the cultural noise, channeling both critique and catharsis into the same breath.



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“Into the Waters” is the band at its most evocative. The track opens with a sense of space, a careful patience in its instrumentation that feels cinematic in scope yet personal in tone. Layers of guitar shimmer and dissolve like waves pulling back from the shore, while the rhythm section pulses with steady restraint, never overpowering but always present, like a heartbeat under the surface. The production leans into atmosphere, every tone bathed in reverb, creating a liminal space between clarity and blur.

The song’s melancholy is undeniable, yet it never collapses into despair. Instead, it carries an undercurrent of movement, as if each chord progression is a step deeper into the water itself. The percussion is particularly striking in its subtlety, more suggestion than declaration, allowing the emotional weight of the song to swell gradually rather than erupt. Vocals emerge as both anchor and guide, haunted but resolute, carrying lyrics that linger like a conversation you can’t forget.

What makes “Into the Waters” resonate is its command of contrast. Church of Elder merges light and shadow without forcing them into opposition. The brightness of melodic passages is tempered by the low hum of bass and the gravity of lyrical themes, creating a duality that feels true to human experience. This is not a song about easy resolutions but about living with both pain and beauty, often in the same breath.

It is also a testament to the band’s maturity. After decades of making music together, Kurätzki, Meiritz, and their collaborators have honed an instinct for pacing and dynamic tension. They know when to hold back, when to let silence stretch, and when to let the sound expand into something almost overwhelming. The result is a track that feels meticulously crafted yet deeply human, a rare combination of precision and vulnerability.

For listeners, “Into the Waters” is more than just a single. It is a reminder of what music can do when it refuses to shy away from the complexities of emotion. Church of Elder offers not a song to be consumed and forgotten, but an invitation to step into a world where grief, longing, and hope all flow together. It is intimate, expansive, and profoundly moving, the sound of a band not just returning, but reaffirming their place in the landscape of music that lingers long after the last note fades.



“Through those decades, the group has navigated shifts in sound and style while holding onto a spirit of collaboration rooted in lifelong friendship. That shared history reverberates through their music, lending it a depth that cannot be manufactured.”

TRANSGALACTICA'S "MARGINAL MUSIC" CHALLENGES THE VALUE OF SOUND IN THE STREAMING ERA

In an age when streaming platforms dominate how we consume art, Transgalactica's new single *Marginal Music* lands less like a song and more like a philosophical provocation. With its blend of meditative mood and catastrophic progressive metal, the track confronts the uncomfortable reality that in 2025 the marginal cost of listening to music has effectively fallen to zero.

The band frames the issue plainly: once you've paid for your monthly subscriptions, Spotify, Netflix, YouTube, internet access, the cost of every additional song or movie feels free. The effect? Listeners become unwilling to pay more, leaving ambitious artists struggling to survive even as technology offers once-unimaginable creative possibilities.

In their own words, if the likes of Bach or Stravinsky were alive today, "music lovers would be in constant ecstasy", yet many modern creators are sidelined by economics.

The single builds its critique with layers of irony, philosophy, and dark wit. Lyrically, *Marginal Music* is as much a cultural essay as it is a track, weaving references to Schopenhauer, Live Nation's monopoly, and even Steven Pinker's optimism about modern progress. The apocalyptic middle section warns listeners that indulging in "trashy music" now could doom them to hearing it for eternity, delivered half as satire, half as haunting prophecy.



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Musically, the band leans into contrasts. The verses carry a meditative, persuasive quality reminiscent of their earlier work on *Discounted Blessings*, while the bridge erupts into a progressive metal storm, chaotic, heavy, and theatrical. This sonic shift mirrors the tension between art as a commodity and art as transcendence. Inspirations are drawn from Bizet's *Carmen*, infusing operatic drama into their modern hybrid of metal, philosophy, and performance art.

Reactions to the single already reflect its intellectual weight. Harvard psychologist Steven Pinker praised it as "marvelous," while listeners like Renek from Poland noted its grandiosity, syncretism, and growing sophistication. True to their ethos, Transgalactica don't ask for cash; instead, they urge fans to support by streaming the track or watching their videos, a paradox at the heart of their own critique.

With *Marginal Music*, Transgalactica aren't just releasing a song, they're staging a cultural intervention. It's music that asks whether we've devalued sound itself in the name of convenience, and whether society's gain in access has come at the cost of art's true worth.

new
release



As artificial intelligence continues to weave itself into the fabric of modern music, a new project out of Montreal is asking a simple but profound question: what makes music human? The answer, at least for so not ai, comes not in criticism or resistance, but in joy.

Launched in June 2025 with the debut single “fa’real fa’real,” so not ai offers an alternative vision for electronic music, one that embraces playfulness, character, and the charm of imperfection. While AI-generated tracks increasingly dazzle with algorithmic precision, this project chooses a different path, committed to celebrating the quirks, grooves, and soulful surprises that arise only from human hands and intuition.

“I listened to some incredible electronic music made recently by AI and it got me wondering, ‘What’s left for us?’” explains the artist behind the project. “I think the answer is character. It’s the goofy soul, the unexpected rhythmic shift, the melodic wit that a human can appreciate. so not ai is my space to explore that. It’s not about being technically perfect; it’s about being perfectly human, flaws, fun, and all.”

The single itself captures this philosophy with a radiant energy. “fa’real fa’real” is a major-key exploration of vibrant rhythms, custom-designed sound effects, and live-played virtual instruments that shimmer with personality.

Drawing inspiration from early IDM and glitch while leaning into a dancier, soulful vibe, the track feels like rediscovered footage from a future-retro dance floor, playful, expressive, and fully alive.

With so not ai, he flips the script, channeling that expertise into something more whimsical, what he calls a “lighter, sillier” side of his practice.

The name itself is a wink at the times: so not ai. It’s a reminder that while technology may continue advancing, there’s still value in imperfection, humor, and human warmth. The sound is retro yet fresh, deliberately quirky, and built to move bodies while sparking grins.

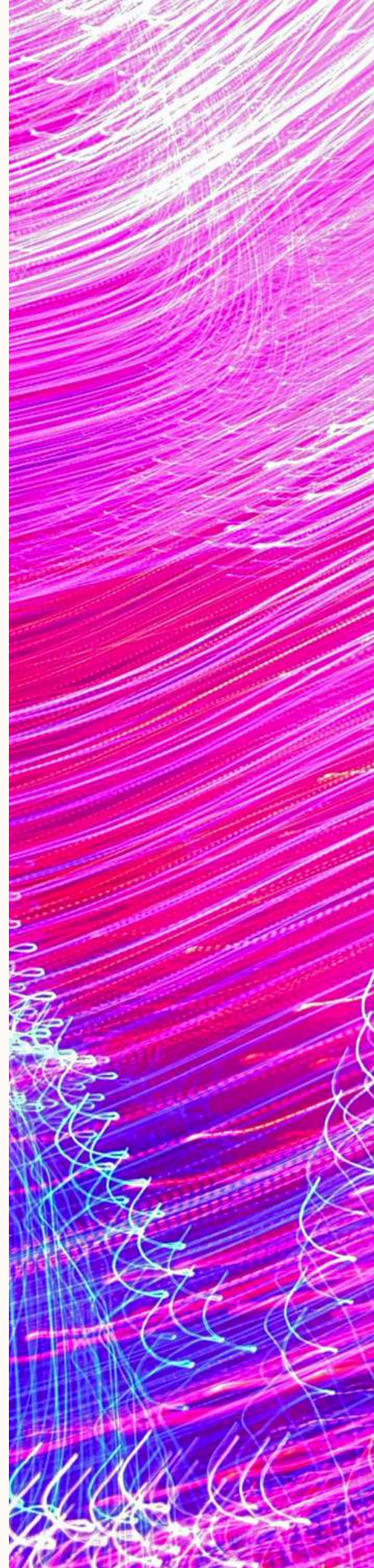
so not ai: Montreal’s Joyful Human Answer to AI in Music

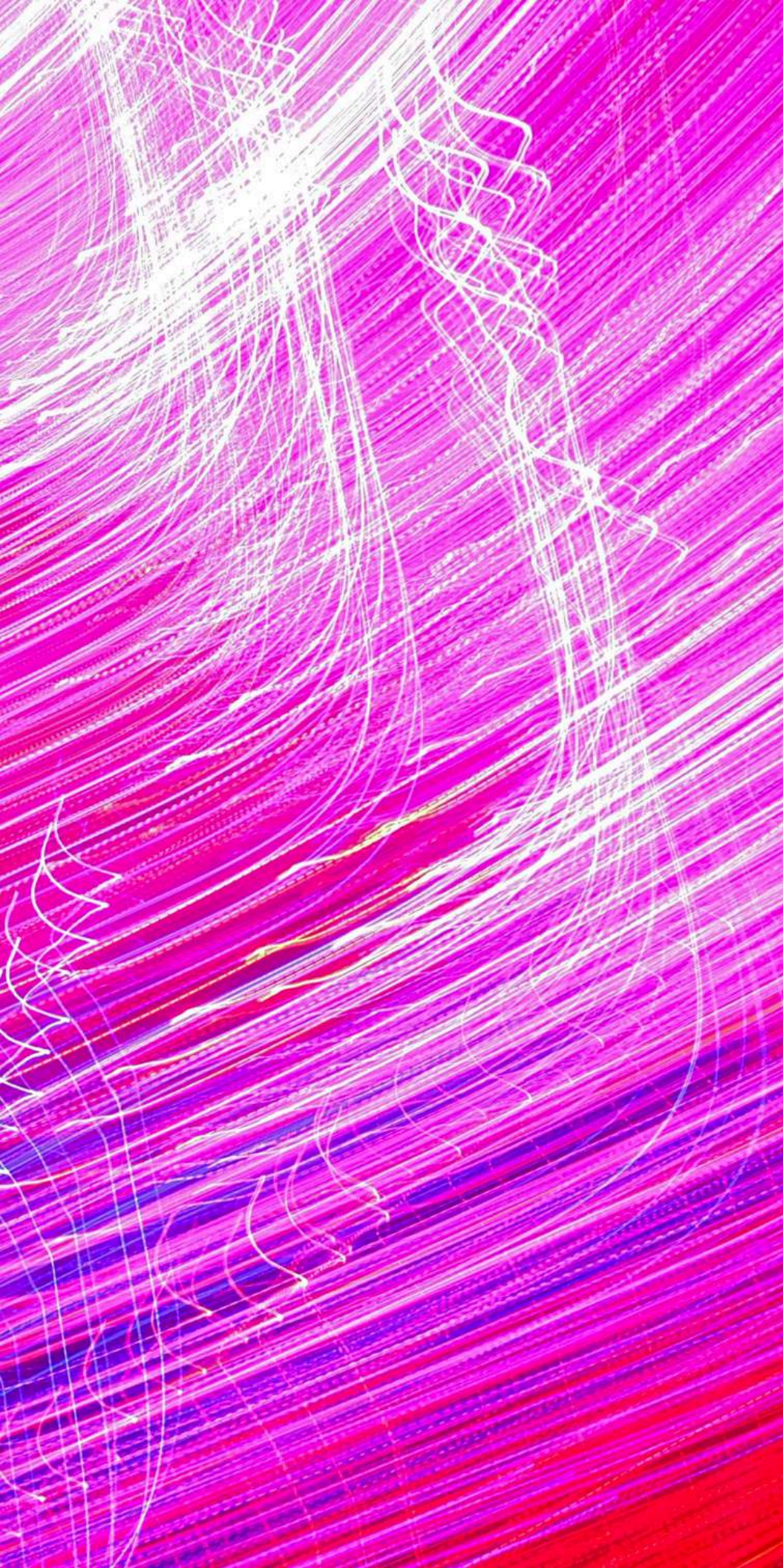
Behind the project is Eldad Tsabary, a long-standing figure in Montreal’s experimental music community. Known internationally for his electroacoustic works and as the founder and director of the Concordia Laptop Orchestra (CLOrk), Tsabary has spent much of his career on the cutting edge of electronic experimentation.

“fa’real fa’real” is more than just a debut single, it’s a manifesto of sorts. In a landscape where AI music risks flattening individuality, so not ai offers a counterpoint: art that is intentionally uneven, joyfully unpredictable, and deeply human at its core.



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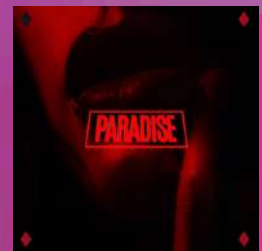




François Marius
Get Ready For The Fun
(Jamaican Version)



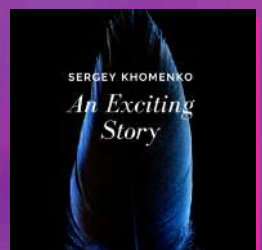
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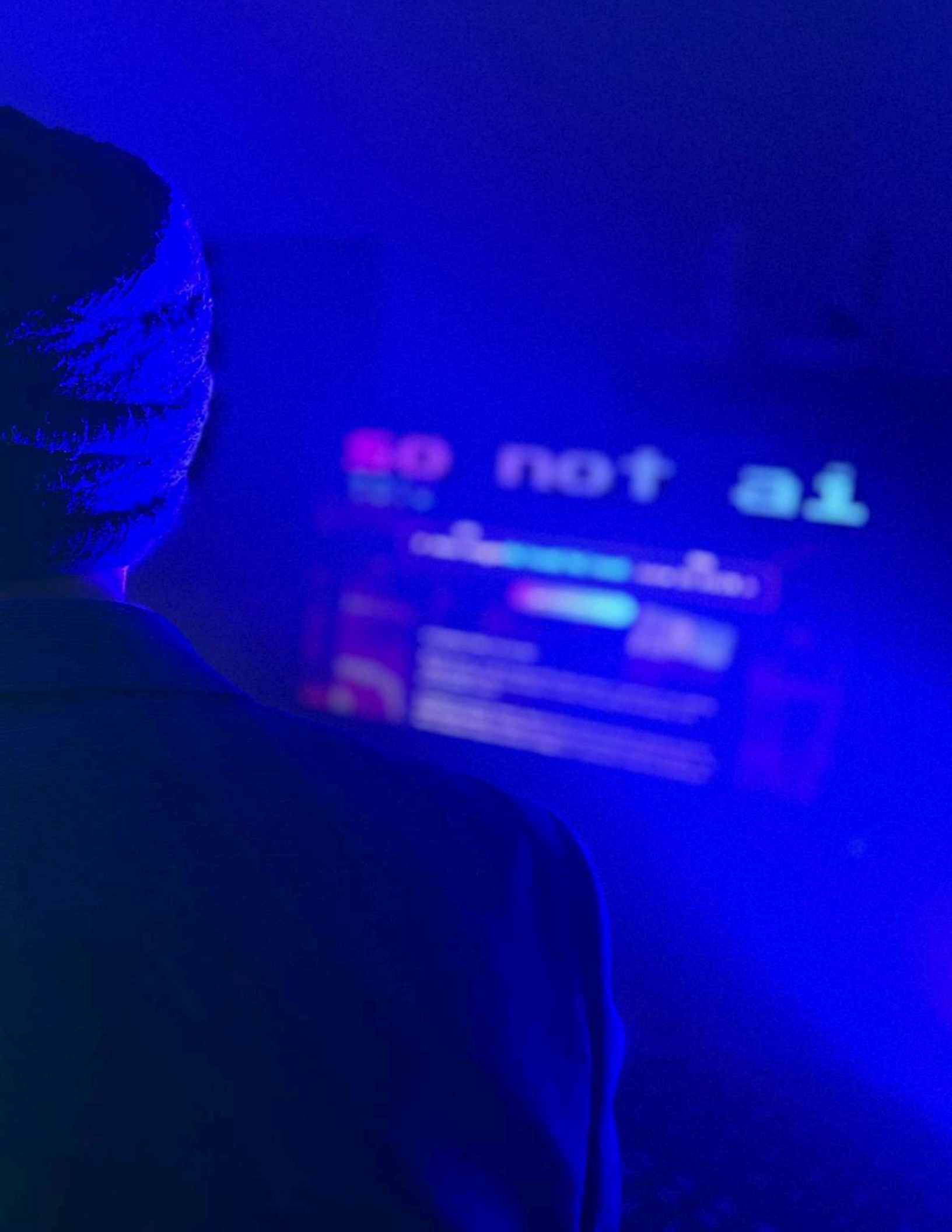


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An Exciting Story





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Georgia-based singer-songwriter Kayla Elise brings her heartfelt storytelling and acoustic charm to the forefront with her latest single, “Your Melody.” At just 20 years old, Kayla is already proving herself as an artist who can turn personal moments into universally relatable songs, weaving emotion into every chord and lyric.

Kayla Elise Channels Raw Emotion in New Single “Your Melody”



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Written in a moment of pure inspiration, “Your Melody” was born from the simple act of picking up her acoustic guitar. As Kayla strummed, melodies and phrases began to emerge naturally, giving shape to a song about unreciprocated passion, the sting of being ghosted, and the frustration of longing left unanswered. Her vocals—honest, unguarded, and tinged with both tenderness and fire—carry the weight of those emotions while the acoustic arrangement keeps the song raw and intimate.

The track resonates because it captures a feeling nearly everyone has experienced: that bittersweet mix of desire and rejection. Instead of masking the pain, Kayla leans into it, allowing listeners to connect with her vulnerability. There’s an

immediacy to the performance, as though each line was lifted directly from the pages of a diary, making the song feel both personal and familiar. What makes “Your Melody” stand out is its authenticity. In a world filled with polished pop production,



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**“Your Melody”
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because it
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and rejection.**

Kayla Elise offers something refreshing: music that’s direct, passionate, and driven by the simple power of a voice and a guitar. Her ability to translate raw emotion into song showcases a maturity beyond her years, hinting at a bright future ahead in the indie-folk and acoustic pop

space. For Kayla, music isn’t just a craft—it’s an outlet, a way of processing and sharing the highs and lows of being human. With “Your Melody,” she gives us not only her song but her story, opening the door for listeners to see themselves in her words. “Your Melody” is now available.

LETTERS FROM A DEAD MAN UNVEILS DREAMY EMOTIONAL SINGLE "LAY DOWN, MY LOVE"

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Indie rock and dream pop often thrive in the spaces between heartbreak and hope, and Letters From a Dead Man's latest single "Lay Down, My Love" captures that liminal territory with cinematic beauty. The track, arriving September 12th as the second single from the forthcoming album *My Only Fear Remains Unseen*, is a stirring meditation on ambition, sacrifice, and the quiet weight of leaving something—or someone—behind.

Built on lush guitar textures, ambient soundscapes, and intimate vocals, "Lay Down, My Love" feels at once expansive and deeply personal. Its sonic palette nods to influences like The 1975, Bon Iver, and Kings of Leon, while carving out its own identity in the way layers of melody and atmosphere intertwine. There's a softness in its dream pop haze, but also a pulse of urgency that makes the song feel alive and cinematic. Lyrically, the track explores the emotional toll of chasing a dream. It's the story of pressing forward into the unknown at the cost of familiar faces and places, an all-too-relatable theme for anyone who has ever risked comfort for passion.



That tension between yearning and loss sits at the heart of "Lay Down, My Love", making it as much a confession as it is an anthem.

What makes the song stand out is its ability to balance intimacy with grandeur. The ambient layers wrap the listener in warmth, while the guitars shimmer with echoes of both post-rock expansiveness and indie rock immediacy. The vocals, delivered with hushed intensity, pull you closer even as the song expands outward, creating a push and pull that feels both tender and epic.

Set within the broader vision of *My Only Fear Remains Unseen*, the single hints at an album rich in atmosphere and emotional storytelling. If "Lay Down, My Love" is any indication, Letters From a Dead Man is crafting a body of work that resonates not just sonically but emotionally, offering listeners a soundtrack for late-night drives, quiet reflections, and the unspoken costs of following one's heart. Perfectly at home on playlists dedicated to indie/alternative rock, dream pop, or post-rock, this is a song for those who crave music that lingers after the final note.

indifferent exclusive

After years of carving a niche in the power-pop and singer-songwriter arenas, Justin Levinson reemerges under the moniker JX Levinson with his debut classical album, *Sans Paroles*. French for “without words,” the album marks a bold artistic reinvention—an intimate journey through emotion conveyed entirely through instrumental storytelling. Levinson explains, “For the past ten years, the lyrics just weren’t showing up. I had hundreds of instrumental song fragments saved in voice memos, but no words. That used to really bum me out. Until one day, I thought: maybe these melodies don’t need words.” What began as scattered piano sketches blossomed into a fully realized orchestral experience, co-produced with Nathaniel Wolkstein.

Sans Paroles unfolds like a cinematic score for a film that exists only in the listener’s imagination. The compositions guide the audience through a romantic arc, from the exhilaration of a first encounter to heartbreak, turbulence, and ultimately reconciliation after long silence. Dark and dramatic passages intertwine seamlessly with moments of hope, showcasing

Every piano motif, string swell, and harmonic layering feels deliberate, creating a lush, immersive soundscape that is both intimate and expansive.

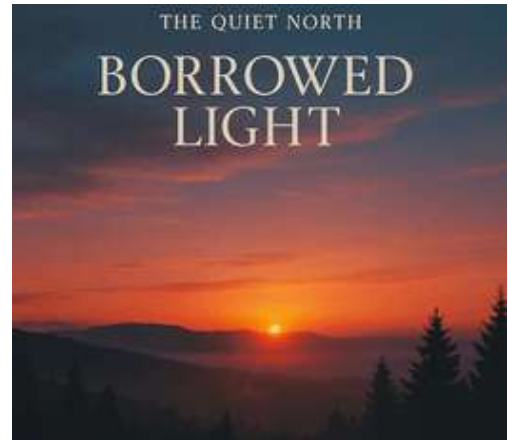
JX Levinson Unveils Cinematic Classical Debut “*Sans Paroles*”

Levinson’s ability to balance emotional depth with musical sophistication. The album highlights Levinson’s skillful orchestration and nuanced arrangements. Every piano motif, string swell, and harmonic layering feels deliberate, creating a lush, immersive soundscape that is both intimate and expansive. It’s an album that doesn’t just invite listeners in, it envelops them, letting the music speak with a language all its own. With *Sans Paroles*, JX Levinson demonstrates that true storytelling transcends words.

This is a quiet, yet powerful reinvention, one that leans into feeling over language, proving that emotion and narrative can flourish purely through melody, texture, and orchestral imagination.



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The Quiet North Illuminate with Cinematic New Single “Borrowed Light”

With their latest release, “Borrowed Light,” The Quiet North create a stunning blend of atmosphere and intimacy, weaving together ambient textures and indie folk into something that feels both expansive and deeply personal. Produced in Norway, the track draws on a truly global collaboration, featuring session musicians from Ukraine, Spain, and South Africa. This international input gives “Borrowed Light” a richness and depth that transcends borders—its sound is as boundless as the fleeting summer skies that inspired it. At its core, the song is a meditation on light, time, and impermanence. Inspired by the delicate glow of northern summers, “Borrowed Light” captures the beauty of moments that are destined to fade, wrapping listeners in layers of soft acoustic warmth, cinematic swells, and hushed vocals that carry both fragility and strength.

The Quiet North approach music like a painter working with shades of light and shadow. Every note and texture is intentional, balancing stillness with movement, intimacy with grandeur. The result is a soundscape that feels like standing in a wide Nordic field at dusk—suspended between day and night, presence and memory.



Norwegian musician Ånon MXXIV invites listeners on an intimate journey through his musical life with his new album *Tellef*. Described as a “snapshot” of himself in 2024, the album blends decades of accumulated musical experience into a deeply personal collection of tunes, some part of his active repertoire, others long-hidden or half-learned pieces now brought to life.

Much of the album showcases Ånon’s longtime companion, the Jew’s harp, an instrument he first picked up at age nine or ten. Drawing on the rich, improvisation-friendly tradition of style icons like Mikkel A. Kaavenes, Aani Rysstad, and Andres K. Rysstad, Ånon navigates both classic material and his own inventive reworkings. Traditional fiddle, *langeleik* (fretted dulcimer), and vocal tunes are distilled into the essential motifs of the Jew’s harp, capturing the spirit of the originals while highlighting the instrument’s unique voice.

Tellef is more than a collection of songs, it’s a reflection on mentorship, memory, and the lifelong impact of musical encounters. Ånon’s careful arrangements honor the masters who inspired him while contributing fresh material, offering listeners a rare blend of reverence and innovation. The album is a celebration of tradition, personal history, and the enduring possibilities of the Jew’s harp as both a vessel and an instrument of storytelling.

Ånon MXXIV’s *Tellef* is a remarkable display of instrumental mastery, weaving together tradition and innovation into a listening experience that is as technically impressive as it is emotionally engaging. From the very first note, it becomes clear that this album is not merely a collection of tunes—it is a meticulous exploration of sound, texture, and musical storytelling, carried entirely through instruments. Each track demonstrates Ånon’s intimate understanding of his chosen mediums, particularly the Jew’s harp, which serves as both the centerpiece and the lens through which the album’s musical universe unfolds. The instrumentation across *Tellef* is nothing short of extraordinary. Ånon draws from a rich palette of traditional Norwegian folk instruments, including the fiddle,

langeleik (fretted dulcimer), and various percussive and resonant tools, blending them seamlessly with the Jew’s harp. The result is a sonic tapestry that balances delicacy and intensity, with each instrument allowed to shine individually while contributing to the larger narrative of the album. The Jew’s harp, in particular, is handled with consummate skill. Ånon manages to convey the subtlety of melody, rhythm, and harmony from an instrument often considered limited in scope. By distilling complex fiddle and dulcimer tunes down to the essence of their motifs, he reveals both the possibilities and constraints of the instrument in a way that feels inventive yet respectful of tradition.

The mixing and production of *Tellef* further elevate the experience. The soundstage is meticulously crafted, giving each instrument space to breathe while maintaining a cohesive sonic identity. Resonances of the harp sit naturally alongside the fuller tones of fiddle and dulcimer, and ambient space is used intelligently to create intimacy without sacrificing depth. The mix enhances the listening experience, highlighting the nuances of each performance, breath, resonance, and subtle tonal shifts, while ensuring that the flow feels natural and immersive. The clarity of the mix allows the appreciation of the interplay between instruments, with details that reward repeated listening.

Ånon MXXIV *Umveils Tellef: A Musical Self- Portrait Across Time*

Equally impressive is the album’s technical execution. Ånon’s playing demonstrates precision, control, and deep musical intuition. Each note is placed with intention, yet the performances never feel mechanical; there is a fluidity and human warmth to the phrasing that keeps the listener immersed. Complex passages are rendered with clarity and finesse, showcasing a mastery of timing, articulation, and subtle dynamics. The technicality is particularly evident in the way Ånon navigates intricate rhythmic patterns and ornamentation, turning potentially demanding compositions into effortless, flowing musical journeys. In essence, *Tellef* is a triumph of instrumental artistry. Ånon MXXIV combines profound

technical skill, inventive instrumentation, and a masterful mix to create a work that is both sophisticated and deeply human.

The album not only pays homage to the rich folk traditions that shaped him but also expands them, demonstrating the remarkable potential of instruments often overlooked. For anyone who values virtuosity, sonic clarity, and innovative instrumental storytelling, *Tellef* is an essential listening experience.



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*Mark Masguro Elevates
Electronic Music with Hypnotic
Mastery in "Whispers"*

Montreal-based visionary Mark Masguro has done it again. With the latest release, *Whispers*, Masguro delivers an emotionally charged, genre-defying single that cements their place as a true sonic innovator.

From the first notes, the track immerses listeners in a multidimensional soundscape, where subtle momentum and spatial design create a gentle disorientation that is both invigorating and mesmerizing.

The song's dynamics are breathtaking. A dramatic beat drop resonates like a heartbeat, grounding the listener while showcasing Masguro's meticulous production. Each element is carefully balanced: the ethereal layers, rhythmic intricacies, and textural flourishes all interact to pull the listener deeper into the music. The production demonstrates a refined sensitivity to spatial acoustics and dynamic movement, transforming *Whispers* into a fully immersive experience. Vocally, the track shines with ritualistic cadence and contemporary sensibility. The voice functions as rhythm, snapping into alignment with the pulsing backdrop, while ethereal harmonies enrich the emotional palette.



Lyrics such as "Close your eyes in the cradle you'll stay" and "Sleep little one in the sweet escapade" reveal the song's core, a reimagined lullaby that walks the line between soothing nostalgia and modern electronic sophistication.

Masguro's approach evokes universal emotional memories while maintaining originality, a testament to both creative vision and technical prowess. The single is just one facet of Masguro's expansive sonic universe. Following *Whispers*, the extended release *Summer Night's Dream (Extended Version)* with Beatman offers glittering synths, intricate drum patterns, and cosmic interludes that feel both spontaneous and deliberate. The track builds to a euphoric climax, demonstrating Masguro's skill in crafting music that is simultaneously cerebral, visceral, and dancefloor-ready.

Mark Masguro consistently defies conventional structures, blending electronic precision with emotional resonance. Each release, from *Whispers* to collaborative works with Beatman, exemplifies a fearless exploration of sound, complex, immersive, and thoroughly human. For listeners seeking music that engages the mind, stirs the body, and elevates the soul, Masguro's work is essential.

With *Whispers*, Mark Masguro doesn't just release a song, he invites listeners into a meticulously crafted world, a hypnotic journey that lingers long after the final note.



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Adam Nelson's "Feed Gaza" Confronts Silence With Sound

In the landscape of modern protest music, there are tracks that cloak their message in metaphor, softening their edges for wider palatability. Adam Nelson has no interest in that. His latest single "Feed Gaza" arrives without disguise, without hesitation, and without apology. It is a blunt demand for empathy, a howl of conscience that refuses to be background noise in a time when too much human suffering is treated like passing content.

Nelson, who works at the intersection of pop, metal, and rock, pours that hybrid energy into a track that feels as much like a cry of grief as it does a battle hymn. The song begins with a stark simplicity, his voice carrying the weight of exhaustion and heartbreak over restrained instrumentation. That sparseness is deliberate, allowing the words to dominate the foreground. He does not hide behind poetic abstraction. Instead, he gives shape to his anguish with lines that strike with the blunt force of lived outrage, calling directly on the privileged to "get off your rich butts and help."

As the song progresses, the production swells, guitars grinding against percussion that grows heavier with each verse. The rhythm section pulses like a heartbeat under stress, urgent and uneven, echoing the sense of crisis at the center of the track. There is a balance of fragility and fury in Nelson's delivery. His voice cracks with grief but sharpens with anger, moving between lamentation and confrontation in a way that mirrors the volatile emotional terrain he is navigating.

The mix captures this duality with precision. The instrumentation never drowns out the vocals, keeping his words at the forefront where they belong. Yet the background layers—distorted guitars, rumbling bass, and crashing cymbals—surge with a storm-like momentum, creating a sonic atmosphere that refuses to let the listener stay passive. The song does not provide resolution. Its rising tension remains unresolved, mirroring the unending reality of the crisis it confronts.



What sets "Feed Gaza" apart is its refusal to operate as a detached commentary. Nelson makes no attempt to universalize or blur the issue. His inspiration came from the images of devastation emerging daily from Gaza, and he treats those images not as distant tragedies but as immediate human catastrophes that demand response. That specificity gives the song its power. It is not only art, it is testimony, and in its urgency, it becomes a form of activism.

In an era where music often bends toward algorithm-friendly neutrality, "Feed Gaza" takes the opposite stance. It is jagged, unvarnished, and confrontational. Listeners will not find escapism here. What they will find is a piece of music that challenges indifference, one that insists on the moral responsibility of those with the privilege to act. Nelson's blend of pop accessibility, rock intensity, and metal edge makes the track both emotionally direct and sonically forceful.



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